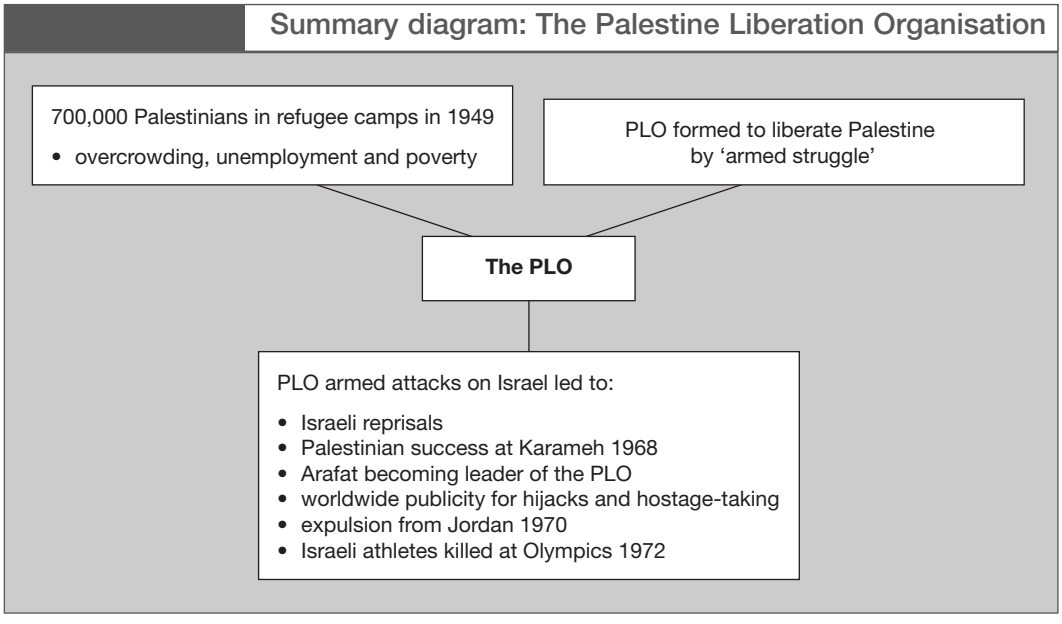
> while others continue to live in our homes. I refuse to remain a refugee. I have decided to join the freedom fighters and I ask for your blessing.

A Palestinian woman, quoted in *The Middle East*, by Walter Oppenheim, explained:

> I am proud that my son did not die in this refugee camp. The foreign press come here and take pictures of us standing in queues to obtain food rations. This is no life. I am proud that my son died in action, fighting on our occupied soil. I am already preparing my eight-year-old for the day he can fight for freedom too.

Summary diagram: The Palestine Liberation Organisation



2 | War in Lebanon

On 10 April 1985 a 16-year-old Muslim girl, Sana M'Heidli, set off on a special mission. She drove a car packed with explosives towards a group of Israeli soldiers in Lebanon and then detonated the charge. She killed herself and two Israelis. We know it was a suicide mission because she explained what she was going to do on video beforehand. The photograph on the next page comes from the video. It was later shown on television in Lebanon.

Key question
Why did the Israelis invade Lebanon in 1978 and 1982?

Crisis in Lebanon

Until the 1970s Lebanon was a fairly stable country and its capital, Beirut, was one of the richest cities in the Middle East. Most of the population were either Christian or Muslim, although both groups were made up of several different sects. Since 1943, they had kept to the agreement that the President would be a Christian and the Prime Minister a Muslim and just over half the